

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

# Theory Training and Tournament Use

Remember the repertoire, handle deviations, update from games, and prepare efficiently

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

# How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

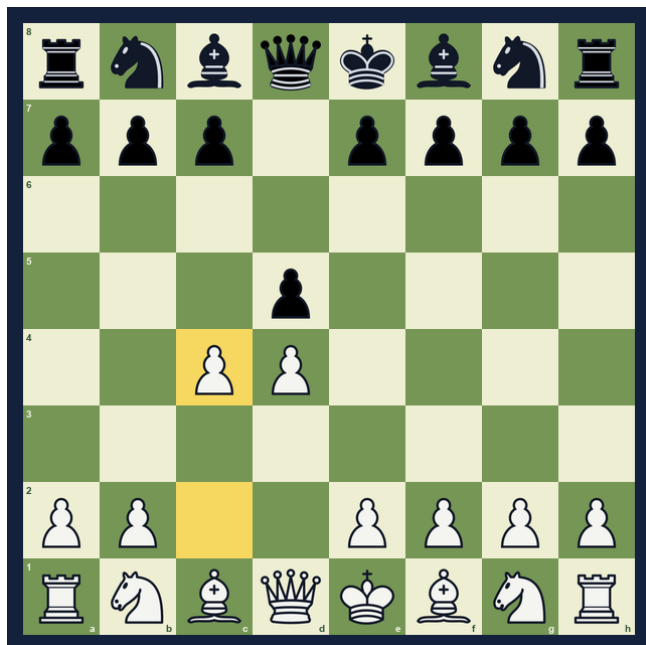
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

## Course Map

| MODULE                             | CHAPTERS |
|------------------------------------|----------|
| THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE | 20       |

# 01. Build the Repertoire Map



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

The course has one answer family for every major Black setup.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Draw the decision tree from 1.d4 and 2.c4 without move details.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4

### MEMORY RULE

First remember families, then branches.

# 01. Decision Framework

## Build the Repertoire Map

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: First remember families, then branches.

## 02. First Ten Moves Against ...d5



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

The normal Queen's Gambit setup provides a safe starting shell.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Reconstruct Nf3, Nc3, e3, bishop development, and castling while naming Black's deviations.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3

#### MEMORY RULE

Know the shell and the moves that change it.

## 02. Decision Framework

### First Ten Moves Against ...d5

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

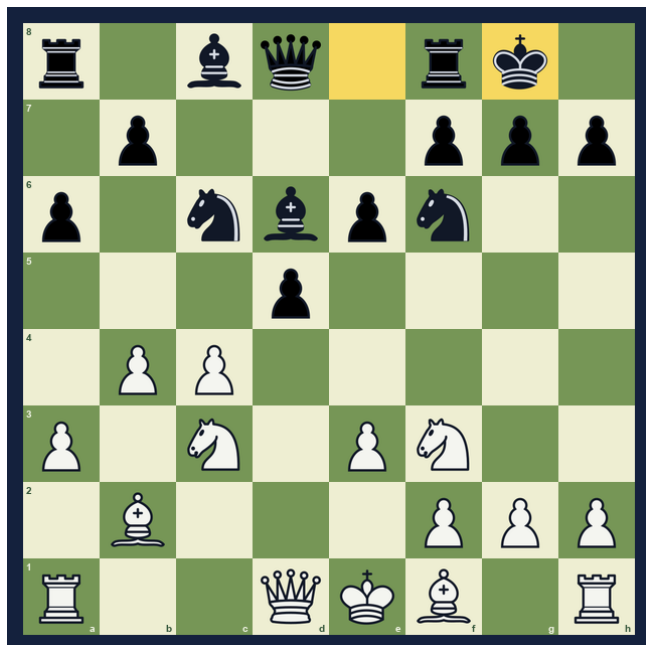
### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Know the shell and the moves that change it.

## 03. First Ten Moves Against ...Nf6



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

Black's second move identifies the Indian family.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Classify ...e6, ...g6, ...c5, and ...d5 before recalling a line.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. e3 Nf6 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. a3 a6 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. b4 Bd6 9. Bb2 O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

Recognize the family before retrieving theory.

## 03. Decision Framework

### First Ten Moves Against ...Nf6

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

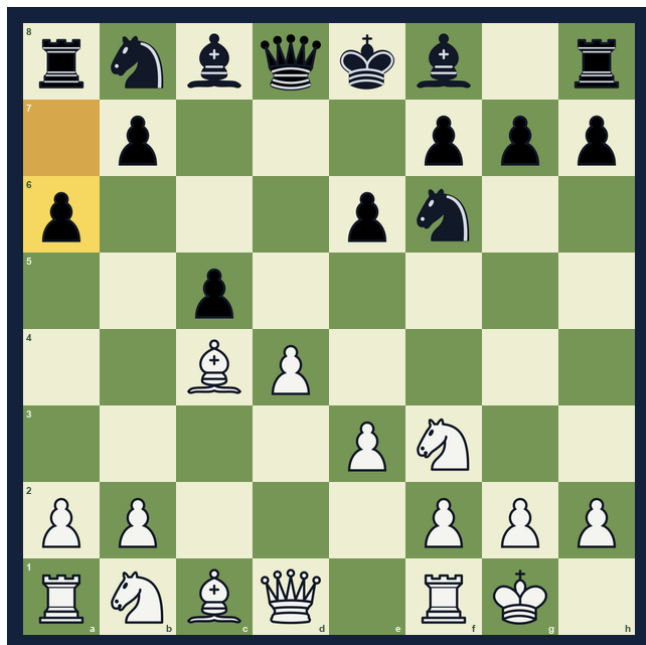
### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Recognize the family before retrieving theory.

## 04. First Ten Moves Against ...f5



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

The Dutch changes king safety and e4 control immediately.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Use the fianchetto setup and challenge Black's center before attacking the king.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

#### MEMORY RULE

Secure the center before exploiting the weakened king.

## 04. Decision Framework

### First Ten Moves Against ...f5

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Secure the center before exploiting the weakened king.

## 05. Rare-Defense Safety Net



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

Unusual moves often sacrifice soundness for surprise.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Build the center, develop, and calculate threats before trying to refute the opening.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 c5 4. e3 cxd4 5. exd4 Nf6 6. Bxc4

#### MEMORY RULE

Do not reward surprise with panic.

## 05. Decision Framework

### Rare-Defense Safety Net

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Do not reward surprise with panic.

## 06. Learn One Branch at a Time



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

Deep study is retained when each session has a small decision boundary.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Study the main line, one deviation, and the resulting plan.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 a6 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. axb5 axb5 7. Rxa8 Bxa8

#### MEMORY RULE

One branch mastered beats ten branches skimmed.

## 06. Decision Framework

### Learn One Branch at a Time

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: One branch mastered beats ten branches skimmed.

## 07. Create Repertoire Flashcards



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

Useful cards ask for a move, reason, counterplay, and plan from a position.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Use the diagram on the front and a four-part answer on the back.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Nf3 c6 6. Bg5 Be7 7. Qc2 O-O 8. e3 Nbd7 9. Bd3 Re8 10. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

Test decisions, not notation alone.

## 07. Decision Framework

### Create Repertoire Flashcards

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Test decisions, not notation alone.

## 08. Store Tabiya Positions



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

Landmarks compress many move orders into one meaningful memory.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Rebuild each tabiya and state the center, breaks, and piece jobs.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Bg5 Be7 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd3 Nbd7 8. Qc2 Re8 9. Nge2 Nf8 10. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

A tabiya is a position plus a decision model.

## 08. Decision Framework

### Store Tabiya Positions

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A tabiya is a position plus a decision model.

## 09. Use Spaced Repetition



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

Theory fades unless recall is spaced after learning.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Review after one day, one week, one month, and after every related game.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Bg5 Be7 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd3 Nbd7 8. Qc2 Re8 9. Nge2 Nf8 10. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

Repetition should be retrieval, not rereading.

## 09. Decision Framework

### Use Spaced Repetition

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

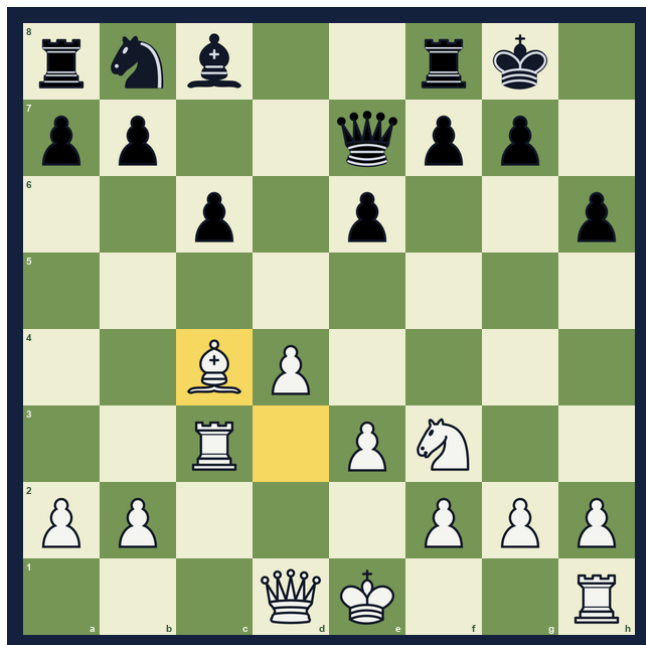
### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Repetition should be retrieval, not rereading.

# 10. Pregame Warmup



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

A short review activates the relevant opening map without exhausting concentration.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Rebuild three key positions and solve one tactical warning.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 h6 7. Bh4 Ne4 8. Bxe7 Qxe7 9. Rc1 c6 10. Bd3 Nxc3 11. Rxc3 dxc4 12. Bxc4

### MEMORY RULE

Warm memory; do not cram branches.

# 10. Decision Framework

## Pregame Warmup

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Warm memory; do not cram branches.

# 11. Postgame Repertoire Update



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

Real games reveal which branch actually needs more theory.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Find the first unfamiliar position and add one human rule.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Nbd7 5. e3 c6 6. Nf3 Qa5 7. Nd2 Bb4 8. Qc2 O-O 9. Be2 dxc4 10. Bxf6 Nxf6 11. Nxc4 Qc7 12. O-O

### MEMORY RULE

Update from games, not from fear of every possibility.

# 11. Decision Framework

## Postgame Repertoire Update

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

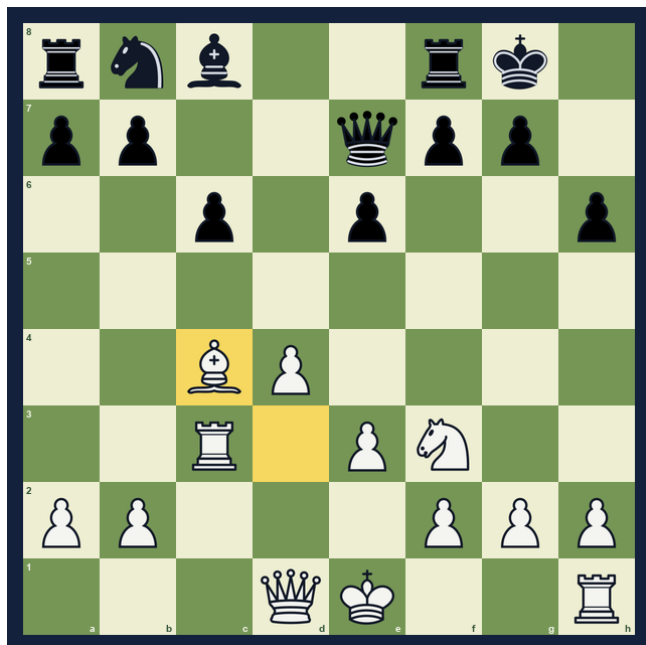
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Update from games, not from fear of every possibility.

## 12. Use the Engine Correctly



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

Engine moves become useful only after they are translated into reasons and alternatives.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Compare your candidate, Black's best reply, and the engine move, then write the structural lesson.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 h6 7. Bh4 Ne4 8. Bxe7 Qxe7 9. Rc1 c6 10. Bd3 Nxc3 11. Rxc3 dxc4 12. Bxc4

#### MEMORY RULE

Store why the move works, not the evaluation number.

## 12. Decision Framework

### Use the Engine Correctly

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Store why the move works, not the evaluation number.

## 13. Study Model Games



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

A model game connects the opening advantage to a middlegame plan and ending.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Pause before every pawn break and predict the plan.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. Qa4+ Nc6 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd2 Re8 8. cxd5 exd5 9. Bd3

#### MEMORY RULE

The opening is learned when you can continue after theory ends.

# 13. Decision Framework

## Study Model Games

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

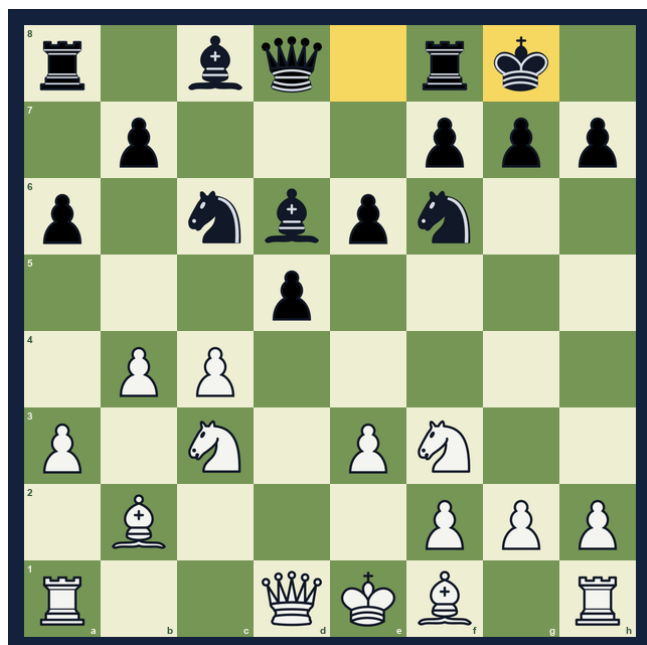
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The opening is learned when you can continue after theory ends.

# 14. Low-Focus Protocol



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

On difficult days, decision quality needs a shorter but reliable routine.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Use threat, forcing moves, loose pieces, center, and worst piece; stop the session after repeated routine failures.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. e3 Nf6 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. a3 a6 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. b4 Bd6 9. Bb2 O-O

### MEMORY RULE

Shorten the candidate list, not the safety scan.

# 14. Decision Framework

## Low-Focus Protocol

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Shorten the candidate list, not the safety scan.

# 15. Opening Clock Management



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

Familiar positions should save time, but unusual moves require a fresh scan.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Move efficiently only after confirming the position still matches the stored landmark.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. cxd5 exd5 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bh4 c5 8. e3 Nc6 9. Bd3 cxd4 10. exd4 O-O

### MEMORY RULE

Familiar shape is not proof of familiar theory.

# 15. Decision Framework

## Opening Clock Management

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Familiar shape is not proof of familiar theory.

# 16. Handle an Opponent's Novelty



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

Most club-level novelties are deviations, not refutations.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Check tactics, identify what the move changed, and return to development and the central plan.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 a6 5. c5 Bf5 6. Bf4 Nbd7 7. e3 Nh5 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 g5 10. Bg3 Nxc3 11. hxg3 Bg7

### MEMORY RULE

Treat novelty as a position, not an emergency.

# 16. Decision Framework

## Handle an Opponent's Novelty

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Treat novelty as a position, not an emergency.

# 17. When Black Deviates Early



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

An unusual move usually leaves a normal developing move available.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Improve the center and worst piece while watching the intended trap.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 dxc4 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. b3 cxb3 7. Qxb3 a6 8. Ba3 Nf6

### MEMORY RULE

Do not invent a refutation when a strong setup is enough.

# 17. Decision Framework

## When Black Deviates Early

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Do not invent a refutation when a strong setup is enough.

# 18. Tournament Preparation



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

Preparation should prioritize likely opponents and recurring structures.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Review the decision tree, tactical warnings, and three model positions rather than every branch.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5

### MEMORY RULE

Prepare landmarks and dangers, not a database dump.

# 18. Decision Framework

## Tournament Preparation

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

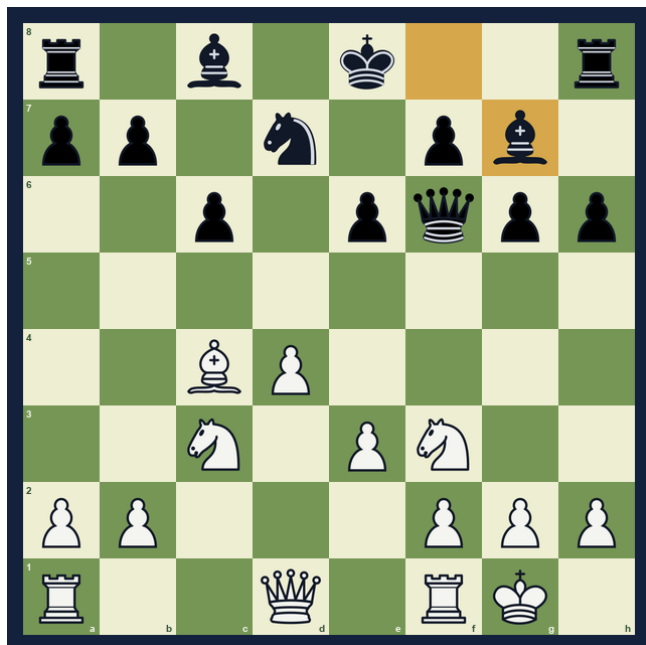
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Prepare landmarks and dangers, not a database dump.

# 19. Monthly Repertoire Maintenance



## THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

### READ THE POSITION

A stable repertoire needs small corrections, not constant replacement.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Audit losses, outdated branches, and positions that still feel planless.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. Bg5 h6 6. Bxf6 Qxf6 7. e3 Nd7 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 g6 10. O-O Bg7

### MEMORY RULE

Repair the weakest branch while preserving the whole system.

# 19. Decision Framework

## Monthly Repertoire Maintenance

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Repair the weakest branch while preserving the whole system.

## 20. Thirty-Day First-Pass Plan



### THEORY TRAINING AND TOURNAMENT USE

#### READ THE POSITION

A month is enough to become playable if study alternates theory, recall, and games.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Week 1 foundations and ...d5; week 2 Indian defenses; week 3 sidelines and structures; week 4 games and repair.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black's best resource is the freeing move, tactical exchange, or piece improvement that challenges this plan.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5

#### MEMORY RULE

Learn, retrieve, play, analyze, and repeat.

## 20. Decision Framework

### Thirty-Day First-Pass Plan

|                                |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK /<br>TRANSFORMATION | Before an irreversible pawn move, picture the forced recapture, new files, new diagonals, and the first piece to use them. |
| PIECE JOB                      | Identify the least active piece and give it a route that supports the structure's main break or target.                    |
| TACTICAL WARNING               | Verify the plan with checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest reply.                           |
| TRADE FILTER                   | Exchange only after naming the favorable feature that survives the recapture.                                              |
| ENDGAME FORECAST               | Forecast the king activity, pawn targets, files, majorities, and minor-piece quality that survive simplification.          |
| CLOCK RULE                     | Spend time on forcing or irreversible choices; move efficiently only in a position you truly recognize.                    |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Learn, retrieve, play, analyze, and repeat.

# Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

## FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.